

A Guide to Practical Next Steps for AI Implementation

ITS America & Cambridge Consultants

Executive Function

Strategic Direction & Decision Making

Key People:
CTO, CDO, Chief Data Officer, Executive Director, Director of Transport Planning

Key Actions:

- Defines AI strategy, alignment and core goals
- Establishes governance structure and KPIs
- Embeds responsible AI culture
- Secures stakeholder and public trust

Operational Function

Building Solid Foundations

Key People:
IT/OT, HR, Legal, Procurement, R&D, Safety, Program management

Key Actions:

- Builds governance and assurance processes
- Manages data quality and infrastructure
- Develops technical capabilities
- Upskills workforce

Delivery Function

AI Implementation on the ground

Key People:
Project delivery, research & innovation, Tech implementation,

Key Actions:

- Runs proof of concept pilots
- Embeds security
- Scales successful initiatives
- Monitors performance



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PATH TO AI MATURITY

SELF-ASSESSMENT WORKSHEET

PURPOSE

This self-assessment worksheet is designed to **help organizations evaluate their current state and readiness for AI implementation**. By working through the guide, your team will align expectations and gain a clear understanding of **how AI maturity is shaped** by your organization's unique context and risk profile, especially in the field of transportation. **Use this tool to identify strengths, pinpoint areas for improvement, and inform your next steps toward responsible, effective AI adoption.**

DIRECTIONS



Bring together a cross-functional team for a **focused 60–90 minute session**.



Work collaboratively through each **section**, discussing evidence and perspectives as you rate your organization's maturity.



Use your scores and insights to **develop a clear action roadmap** for the next 12 months.



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A GUIDE TO PRACTICAL NEXT STEPS FOR AI IMPLEMENTATION



AI Governance Group: The Executive Function

Providing strategic direction, accountability, and responsible leadership for AI in transportation organizations

The Executive Function is the cornerstone of successful AI adoption in transportation organizations. It establishes a clear AI strategic direction aligned with organizational goals and ensures initiatives deliver meaningful and responsible impact.

Executive Function roles include:

- Executive Director
- Director of Transportation Planning
- Chief Technical Officer
- Chief Data Officer
- Chief AI Officer
- Other senior leaders responsible for aligning AI with transportation priorities

The Executive Function is accountable for:



1
Defining AI Strategic Direction



2
Championing a Responsible AI culture



3
Establishing AI governance structures

1 Define AI Strategic Direction

Leadership sets the tone for AI success.

Executives must:

- Assess how AI advances priorities and align AI strategy with organizational goals and readiness.
- Approve pilots and proofs of concept with clear business cases and measurable KPIs.
- Rely on operational assessments to guide decisions, ensuring AI deployments meet safety, effectiveness, and responsibility standards.
- Ensure ongoing AI implementation aligns with strategy, safety, effectiveness, and organizational priorities.

WHY IT MATTERS

Strategic direction serves as a roadmap for aligning AI efforts with organizational goals and informs all other functions on priorities, actions, and integration.

A GUIDE TO PRACTICAL NEXT STEPS FOR AI IMPLEMENTATION



AI Governance Group: The Delivery Function

Carrying out effective implementation of AI across transportation organizations

The Delivery Function translates AI strategy into transportation deployments, scaling solutions from pilots to production while ensuring safety, security, and alignment with sector priorities. It aligns AI initiatives to organizational goals through clear metrics and strong governance, with cybersecurity, safety, and public trust embedded throughout delivery.

The Delivery Function includes teams in:

- Project Delivery
- Procurement
- Research and Innovation
- Technology Implementation
- Public Affairs

From Proof of Concept to Scale

AI implementation typically progresses through three stages:

1 Proof of Concept (PoC)

PoCs are designed to demonstrate feasibility for a specific use case. They are often developed in controlled or research environments and focus on validating concepts, methods, or technologies with limited scope and risk.

2 Pilot Deployments

Pilots involve the design and implementation of AI solutions in real-world environments. They build upon lessons learned from PoCs and require greater organizational commitment, resources, and cost. Pilots provide critical insight into operational performance, user interaction, and system impacts.

3 Scaled Implementation

Decisions to scale AI solutions require a comprehensive strategic business case and cost-benefit analysis. Evidence gathered from pilot deployments helps assess impacts, benefits, and risks relative to transportation goals, providing the foundation for informed investment and broader deployment.



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A GUIDE TO PRACTICAL NEXT STEPS FOR AI IMPLEMENTATION



AI Governance Group: The Operational Function

Enabling safe, trustworthy, and scalable AI across transportation organizations

The Operational Function translates strategy into execution by establishing the processes, tools, and capabilities for responsible AI deployment. It ensures integrity, privacy, and appropriate use, evaluates where AI should be applied, and continuously monitors implementations to maintain these standards.

The Operational Function includes teams managing:

- District Operations
- Human Resources
- IT/OT Infrastructure
- Legal and Regulatory
- Procurement
- Program Development
- Program/Project Delivery
- Research and Development
- Safety Operations

The Operational Function is accountable for:



1
Establishing governance and assurance processes



2
Developing data and technical capabilities



3
Building workforce skills

1 AI Governance Processes: Building the Framework for Responsible AI

AI governance in transportation must align with guiding principles, best practices, and regulations while integrating seamlessly with existing IT, data, regulatory, and organizational governance systems. A tailored governance structure is essential to manage unique risks and ensure transparency, traceability, and accountability across the entire AI lifecycle.

Governance Processes should:

- ✓ Define organizational roles and responsibilities for AI decision-making
- ✓ Embed AI principles, regulations, and policies across teams
- ✓ Set KPIs to measure progress and impact
- ✓ Ensure traceability, documentation, and risk tracking
- ✓ Maintain a central use case and risk repository

WHY IT MATTERS

Creates consistency, transparency, and accountability across the AI lifecycle, from design and procurement to deployment and monitoring.